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At Start of Production, AESC Hosts President Macron at Douai Battery Gigafactory



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Douai, France – AESC, a global leader in the development and manufacturing of high-performance batteries for electric vehicles and energy storage systems, hosted a ceremony announcing the Start of Production (SOP), at its state-of-the-art gigafactory in Douai, France.

Today's event was joined by French President Emmanuel Macron, whose attendance illustrates the importance of this milestone for France's transition towards sustainable mobility.

The Douai gigafactory, built with the support of prestigious French and European financial partners including Bpifrance, Caisse des Dépôts et Consignations, European Investment Bank and a syndicate of leading commercial banks, represents a landmark investment in the

reindustrialization of France and the decarbonization of the European automotive sector.

With an annual production capacity of 10 GWh, the facility currently supplies advanced batteries for Renault, with the potential to power up to 200,000 electric vehicles per year. It already provides 650 high-quality green jobs, with the workforce expected to grow to 1,000 at full production capacity.

Emmanuel Macron, President of France, said: "Here in Douai, we are turning a new page in the history of French industry. The inauguration of the AESC gigafactory—launched as part of Choose France in 2021—is the culmination of eight years of determined effort. This flagship project reflects a uniquely French vision of ecological transition: one that unites innovation, development, job creation, and sustainable ambition. It will transform the lives of an entire region—its employees, their families, and the wider community. I applaud the dedication of our partners, local authorities, and all those clear-sighted optimists who, like me, believe in France's

capacity to lead. Together, we are shaping an industry that will strengthen Douai, uplift the region, and contribute to a more sovereign and prosperous Nation."

Lei Zhang, Chairman of AESC, commented: "The start of production at our Douai gigafactory marks a pivotal step in AESC's commitment to advancing France's reindustrialization and leadership in the global energy transition. By investing in cutting-edge battery technology and skilled talent, we are proud to help accelerate the decarbonization of transportation worldwide. France's bold vision for clean mobility continues to inspire us every day."

The Douai plant is powered by clean electricity and features advanced manufacturing processes, including electrode production, cell assembly, and module integration. AESC continues to invest in local recruitment through ongoing hiring initiatives in partnership with regional educational institutions and employment agencies.

About AESC

AESC is a global leader in advanced lithium-ion battery technologies and energy storage system solutions, dedicated to accelerating the global transition to sustainable energy.

Headquartered in Japan, the Company operates across France, Spain, the U.K, North America and Asia, developing and manufacturing high-performance, zero-emission battery solutions for energy storage systems ("ESSs") and electric vehicles ("EVs").

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